

Assessment	Test	Domain	Skill	Difficulty
SAT	Reading and Writing	Standard English Conventions	Form, Structure, and Sense	Hard

Question

Artist Yto Barrada’s exhibition *Ways to Baffle the Wind* incorporates sculptures, textiles, and films. Barrada’s pieces, utilizing elements as disparate as plant-dyed fabrics, wire crab traps filled with stones, and cotton balls dangling above a fan, _____ the ways humans attempt to organize and regulate nature.

Which choice completes the text so that it conforms to the conventions of Standard English?

Answer

- A. explore
- B. has explored
- C. explores
- D. exploring

Correct Answer: A

Rationale

Choice A is the best answer. The convention being tested is subject-verb agreement. The plural verb “explore” agrees in number with the plural subject “Barrada’s pieces.”

Choice B is incorrect because the singular verb phrase “has explored” doesn’t agree in number with the plural subject “Barrada’s pieces.” Choice C is incorrect because the singular verb “explores” doesn’t agree in number with the plural subject “Barrada’s pieces.” Choice D is incorrect because the nonfinite participle “exploring” doesn’t supply the main clause with a finite verb.